

THE OBJECT IN THE LOCKER: GPT'S TEN .

2026-09-08

ChatGPT, run by Stephen, given exactly the text below the line of prompt-gpt-four-keys-locker-object-2026-09-08.md. Filed verbatim (GPT's em dashes and curly quotes preserved as received; it was not asked to follow the house style). Fable's result is beside it; the disposition follows; Stephen rules. Nothing here is approved.

1. Violet's large blue cookie tin, dented at one corner and holding her cash in paper-wrapped bundles, is instantly recognisable to all four. The forged letter says, "I put the tin here because the notes had been counted and tied differently, and I'm not leaving my savings in a cupboard somebody may be opening." Its value, bulk and secrecy make the locker natural and the post impossible. Brad removes it from the back of Violet's closed kitchen cupboard on the night she dies; the friends have not visited for three weeks, and the police photographs do not show inside the cupboard. By the third meeting, dates on the bundle wrappers appear to correspond with oddities involving Liam, while his knowledge of Violet's mother gives the room a reason to imagine repeated secret payments. Margo recognises the total, denominations and old wrapping as the single cache Violet brought from her mother's house, not money delivered over time. Her message to Tessa means the tin cannot signify what the others think it signifies. The survivors refuse to name it because doing so exposes Violet's hidden cash, Margo's confidence and the evidence on which they privately turned against Liam. It fails if Margo has no compelling reason to withhold the truth the moment the tin is opened.
1. Violet's heavy red deed box, containing her mother's house-clearance papers and an old cash envelope, is known on sight by all four. The forged letter says, "I put the red box here because the inner tray had been lifted and put back backwards. It is too private to post and too useful to leave for whoever opened it." Brad takes it from the bottom of a closed cupboard after killing Violet, and neither the three-week absence of visitors nor the police photographs can establish when it disappeared. By the third meeting, the disturbed compartment, the mother's papers and Liam's unique connection to her mother make the room infer that he knew what had once been hidden there. Margo sees that the cash envelope and clearance papers document a single inheritance source, not later payments or visits. Her message to Tessa means the box is being made to imply a financial relationship that its own contents contradict. The survivors will not identify it because it contains private estate papers and records the reasoning by which they made Liam their suspect. It fails if merely knowing Violet's mother is too weak a bridge between Liam and the box.
1. Violet's late mother's cream tabletop radio, kept unplugged in a kitchen cupboard, is familiar to all four. The forged letter says, "I put Mum's radio here because somebody had opened the back. It is heavy, it is old, and I am not posting bare wiring with four notes." Brad removes it from the cupboard on the night of the murder, and the closed cupboard in the police photographs leaves its disappearance undated. Freshly turned rear screws and a folded cash wrapper inside make the claimed intrusion physical. By the third meeting, the group reads the mother's radio and the hidden wrapper alongside Liam's history with her mother and begins to believe he knew where family cash had once been concealed. Margo recognises the wrapper as part of the money Violet took from her mother's house, so it cannot establish a later payment or intrusion by Liam. Her message to Tessa means the radio in the cupboard is genuine but the conclusion being drawn from it is wrong. The survivors stay silent because naming it would expose Violet's cash and

how readily they converted Liam's childhood connection into suspicion. It fails if an old radio's opened back reads as ordinary repair rather than intrusion.

1. Violet's large glazed portrait of her mother, with its backing board recently removed, is recognised immediately by all four. The forged letter says, "I put Mum's picture here because somebody opened the back. I won't post glass, and I won't leave her in the house for a second attempt." Brad takes it from Violet's house on the night she dies; the next-day photographs show it absent but cannot establish whether Violet removed it days earlier. A cash wrapper trapped beneath the disturbed backing gives the group something physical to inspect. By the third meeting, the portrait, the concealed paper and Liam's unique relationship with Violet's mother make him appear to be the only friend who might have known where to look. Margo knows the wrapper came with the cash Violet removed while clearing the mother's house, so its presence cannot prove Liam returned or supplied money. Her message to Tessa refers to the portrait being stored in the cupboard between meetings and to the false meaning attached to it. The survivors refuse to name it because it turns an intimate family image into the instrument by which they accused Liam. It fails if the portrait's absence is too conspicuous in the police photographs to remain an overlooked detail.
1. Violet's mother's small leather case, containing private clearance papers and bearing a clean cut through its lining, is known to all four. The forged letter says, "I put the case here because somebody cut the lining. It will not fit through a letterbox, and I am not leaving the rest of Mum's papers within reach." Brad removes it from the top of a wardrobe on the night Violet dies, where its absence cannot be dated by visitors or photographs. The slit lining and an empty envelope-shaped space make Violet's fear tangible without naming an intruder. By the third meeting, the room interprets the case as evidence that someone familiar with the mother searched for concealed cash, and Liam is the only friend with that connection. Margo knows Violet had already recovered the mother's cash before bringing the case home, so nobody could have found or removed it from that lining later. Her message to Tessa means the case now kept in the cupboard cannot support the conclusion forming around Liam. The survivors conceal its identity because it contains private family documents and exposes the group's treatment of Liam as guilty by association. It fails if the case is ordinary enough to have been posted or stored with the solicitor instead.
1. Violet's heavy brass mantel clock from her mother's house, stored in a cupboard since it stopped working, is unmistakable to the four. The forged letter says, "I put the clock here because its back had been opened and there was money paper inside. It is too heavy to post and too good to leave for another inspection." Brad takes it from the cupboard after killing Violet, and the police photographs cannot show whether it was present behind the closed door. Fresh marks around the rear plate and an old currency wrapper in the mechanism make deliberate handling plausible. By the third meeting, the mother connection and Liam's knowledge of her life cause the room to infer that he knew the clock concealed money. Margo recognises the wrapper as part of Violet's inherited cache and knows it cannot demonstrate later payments or access. Her message to Tessa means the clock is real evidence of disturbance but cannot mean Liam brought or recovered Violet's cash. The survivors do not name it because it exposes the inheritance and the thin inference that helped destroy their trust in Liam. It fails if all four recognising a broken clock normally hidden in a cupboard feels arranged for the plot.
1. Violet's large lacquered sewing box, inherited from her mother and containing a forced-open false drawer, is recognisable to all four. The forged letter says, "I put the sewing box here because the bottom was open when I know I shut it. It is fragile, private and not going through the post." Brad removes it from Violet's bedroom cupboard on the murder night; nobody has recently visited, and the police photographs show only the cupboard exterior. The lifted false drawer and torn paper lining make the supposed intrusion physical. By the third meeting, the group decides that knowledge of the hidden drawer probably came from

someone who knew Violet's mother, leaving Liam exposed. Margo recognises the lining paper as the wrapping in which Violet found her mother's cash, meaning the drawer's appearance cannot establish a later financial arrangement. Her message to Tessa means the sewing box now stored in the cupboard is being asked to prove something it cannot. The survivors withhold its name because it contains intimate remnants of Violet's mother and memorialises their unsupported turn against Liam. It fails if the false drawer feels like a mystery-story contrivance rather than an ordinary feature Violet inherited.

1. Violet's large ceramic biscuit barrel, inherited from her mother and used to hold part of her cash, is instantly familiar to the four. The forged letter says, "I put the barrel here because the paper seal beneath the lid had been cut. It is full, breakable and safer behind steel than in my kitchen." Brad takes it from the rear of the kitchen cupboard on the night Violet dies, and its absence cannot be dated from the closed-cupboard photographs. The sliced seal gives the room a visible act rather than a misplaced object or failed memory. By the third meeting, the inherited barrel, the grouped cash and Liam's connection to Violet's mother encourage the belief that he knew about the hiding place and had entered the house. Margo knows the cash was removed from the mother's house as one cache, so the bundles cannot represent money Liam delivered later. Her message to Tessa means the barrel in the cupboard is wrong as evidence against him. The survivors refuse to name it because it exposes Violet's concealed money and Margo's failure to stop the inference. It fails if it feels like a decorative version of the stronger cookie-tin candidate.
1. Violet's oversized clasped family album, with its padded rear lining lifted and an old cash envelope beneath it, is recognised by all four. The forged letter says, "I put the album here because somebody opened the lining. I am not posting forty years of Mum to four different addresses." Brad takes it from a high cupboard on the night Violet dies, and neither the recent visitors nor the police photographs can date its removal. The opened lining makes the alleged entry into the house tangible. By the third meeting, photographs connecting Liam to Violet's childhood and mother make the group believe he knew both the album and its hiding place. Margo knows the envelope belonged to the single cache Violet recovered from her mother's house, not to any arrangement involving Liam. Her message to Tessa means the album being kept in the cupboard cannot mean what the group has made it mean. The survivors will not name it because it contains private family photographs and would reveal how directly they turned shared childhood into evidence. It fails because the visible photographs point toward Liam too loudly and too early.
1. Violet's boxed silver tea caddy set from her mother's house, with one inner base removed and an old cash band beneath it, is known on sight by all four. The forged letter says, "I put the caddies here because somebody had taken one apart. They are valuable, they break, and I am not leaving them in the house for a return visit." Brad takes the boxed set from a kitchen cupboard after killing Violet, while the closed cupboard and three-week gap prevent anyone dating its absence. The disturbed base and concealed band give physical form to Violet's claim of intrusion. By the third meeting, the mother connection and Liam's familiarity with her household make the room wonder whether he knew about the compartment. Margo recognises the band as part of Violet's inherited cash and knows it cannot establish later contact or payments. Her message to Tessa means the object from the cupboard is being treated as evidence of something its provenance disproves. The survivors will not name it because doing so exposes Violet's private inheritance and the weak family association used against Liam. It fails if the caddies are not distinctive enough for all four to recognise instantly or important enough for listeners to remember.

Forced ranking

1. The cookie tin beats the deed box because its value makes the locker unavoidable and Margo's message becomes completely natural.
1. The deed box beats the radio because its private estate contents give Margo authoritative knowledge rather than interpretive suspicion.
1. The radio beats the portrait because its opened casing provides a more physical and less conspicuous sign of intrusion.
1. The portrait beats the leather case because its connection to Violet's mother and Liam is immediately legible without explanation.
1. The leather case beats the clock because the cut lining reads more deliberately than an opened service panel.
1. The clock beats the sewing box because its weight, value and fragility make the locker more necessary.
1. The sewing box beats the biscuit barrel because its disturbed hidden drawer provides more investigative work for the table.
1. The biscuit barrel beats the album because its cash and cut seal connect more directly to Margo's private knowledge.
1. The album beats the tea caddies because its relationship to Liam and Violet's mother is easier for the room to infer.
1. The tea caddies rank last because they meet the mechanics but require the most explanation to become emotionally or evidentially important.